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quality of water, so that it becomes health hazard or unfit to use."

The water pollutants originate from both natural and human activities. The source of water pollution is classified as Point and Non-point source.

Easily identified source of place of pollution is called as point source. Example: municipal and industrial discharge pipes.

Non-point source cannot be identified easily, example: agricultural runoff, mining wastes, acid rain, and storm-water drainage and construction sediments.

Table 15.2: List of major water pollutants and their sources.

No	Pollutant	Sources
1	Microorganisms	Domestic sewage, domestic waste water, dung heap
2	Organic wastes	Domestic sewage, animal excreta, food processing factory waste, detergents and decayed animals and plants,
3	Plant nutrients	Chemical fertilisers
4	Heavy metals	Heavy metal producing factories
5	Sediments	Soil erosion by agriculture and strip-mining
6	Pesticides	Chemicals used for killing insects, fungi and weeds
7	Radioactive substances	Mining of uranium containing minerals
8	Heat	Water used for cooling in industries

15.6 Causes of water pollution

(i) Microbiological (Pathogens)

Disease causing microorganisms like bacteria, viruses and protozoa are most serious water pollutants.

They come from domestic sewage and animal excreta. Fish and shellfish can become contaminated and people who eat them can become ill. Some serious diseases like polio and cholera are water borne diseases.Human excreta contain bacteria such as Escherichia coli and Streptococcus faecalis which cause gastrointestinal diseases